

CHAPTER 4: THE CARDS IN DEPTH

Rage is played with three different kinds of cards: Characters, sept, & combat cards.

4.1 CHARACTER CARDS

Character cards are the two-sided cards which represent the individuals in the game. One side of the card depicts that Character's breed form, the form in which he goes about his daily business. The other side illustrates the Character's crinos - or battle - form, which is his combat ready killing machine form. Note that on some Characters, they are the same on both sides as they only have one form.

Each player may only put one of a given Character in their deck, but the same Character may appear in any number of packs. Multiple characters break this rule; a player can have up to five copies of a Multiple character in their starting pack.

During the game, two (or more) characters with the same name can be forced into a pack together by card effects.

4.1.1. NAME

Like you don't know what a name is.

4.1.2 SET GLYPH

Each release of Rage has a glyph in the upper left-hand corner. This glyph indicates which expansion the card is from.

4.1.3 RENOWN

Renown appears in the upper right corner. A Character's Renown is a reflection of how well-esteemed and able-bodied the Character is, and it dictates the amount of Victory Points that the Character is worth when killed. The Renown level of the game is also the limit of the combined total renown of your starting Characters.

4.1.4 STATS

Each Character in **Rage** has three statistics which define her abilities:

- Rage defines the combat prowess of the Character.
- Gnosis indicates the level of her spiritual attunement.
- Health reflects the Character's ability to withstand combat.

All Characters regenerate. Some older Characters whose creature class does not regenerate, have "(Regenerates)" written beneath their Stats.

4.1.5 ALLEGIANCE

All Characters cards released in PDF sets bear a glyph declaring their allegiance;

- Gaia Characters defend Gaia by cleansing the world of the Wyrms. They may only be put into Gaia packs.
- Wyrms Characters seek to destroy or corrupt the world around them. They may only be put into Wyrms packs.
- Some Rogue Characters are torn between their duty to Gaia and the lure of the Wyrms; other Rogues merely have an agenda that crosses into both camps. Rogues may be put into either Gaia or Wyrms packs.

Rage is a game of Gaia's servants against those of the Wyrms. When creating a deck, choose an Allegiance: Gaia or Wyrms. All characters put in the deck must be of that Allegiance, the resulting pack will always have that Allegiance and any Allies in the pack will also have that Allegiance.

Allegiance, like keywords, determines which cards creatures can play and benefit from.

- Gaia creatures can play Moots and Fetish equipment but not Bane Fetishes or Board Meetings.
- Wyrms creatures can play Board Meetings and Bane Fetish equipment but not Fetishes or Moots. Wyrms Characters cannot use Auspice Gifts. They can use Breed gifts.
- Card abilities can override these restrictions.

Creatures which change pack, either temporarily or permanently, lose their old Allegiance and gain the Allegiance of their new pack.



(if they change pack again-including returning to their original pack- their Allegiance may change again.)

All Enemies are considered Wyrms creatures. All Victims are considered Gaia creatures.

Characters from older sets, who do not have an Allegiance Glyph, have to be identified by creature class and faction. All 7th Generation, Pentex, Black Spiral Dancer and Bane Characters are Wyrms affiliated, as is any Character with a Wyrms Aspect listed (e.g. Morgan, Count Vladimir Rustovich). All other Characters, with the exception of Conrad, are Gaia Characters.

4.1.5.A ROGUES

Rogues were introduced in Ahadi, although *Conrad Walks-the-Line* from Legacy of the Tribes counts as a Rogue. Rogues may be used as either Gaia or Wyrms Characters during deck construction, although a pack must have at least one non-Rogue. There are no Rogue affiliated packs - packs can only be Gaia or Wyrms.

Once a game begins, Rogues gain the allegiance of their pack. They do not change creature class or tribe, and retain use of all their keywords, but follow the restrictions of their pack's allegiance (as above). So a Rogue Wendigo in a Wyrms pack becomes a Wyrms Character and could use Bane Fetishes and Wendigo Gifts but not the *War Lodge* (a Fetish); it does not become a Black Spiral Dancer. Rogue Characters do not have Aspects, although they may gain them through card abilities.

4.1.6 KEYWORDS

Definition: Multiple- You can start with up to five copies of a Multiple Character in your pack.

Each Character has keywords which define its creature class, faction, breed and spiritual role. These keywords are mostly found on the coloured strip above the Stats and Text Box, but additional keywords can be found at the beginning of the Text Box, a word or expression followed by a full stop (e.g. "Eater-of-Souls." or "Kailindo."). All keywords dictate which cards the Character can play or benefit from (for instance Kiss of Helios requires an Ahroun, while Ahrouns get an extra benefit when a Full Moon is in play). Additionally, the creature class determines whether the Character can frenzy or Step Sideways. Where a creature has more than one creature class, it has the abilities of both (e.g. an Abomination - Garou/Vampire - can step sideways because a Garou can step sideways, although a Vampire cannot). Garou can step sideways, although a Vampire cannot). See Appendix 1: keywords

When creatures with multiple Keywords or classes have conflicting abilities where one class can do something, and one class can not do the same thing, CAN takes precedence. So the Garou Vampire can step sideways. This breaks the general Can't vs must effect rule. See a chart of creature classes and their abilities

4.1.7 TEXT BOX

The text box consists of three elements:

- **Keywords:** These cannot be blanked or changed unless a card refers to keywords explicitly.
- **Special Ability:** Characters have unique benefits or flaws explained here.
- **Flavor:** Text which is neither a keyword nor a rules effect is flavor, and has no affect on the game other than to enhance its mood.

Most creatures carry an indication of their gender in their flavor text and special ability, and sometimes their creature class.

4.1.8 FORMS

The breed form is the natural form of the Character (normally Homid or an animal form), indicates the Breed of the Character (see keywords) and is the form that the Character starts the game in. In most cases, breedform stats are lower than crinos-form stats.

Most Characters are able to transform into a battle form, which is represented by having two-sided Character cards. One side is the crinos (for Shapeshifters) or battle form (some Wyrms Characters). To all extents and purposes these two forms are the same and the terms are synonymous. The other side of the card is the breed form, which varies from creature to creature.

Changing between forms is represented by flipping the Character card. Some Character cards are the same on both sides. In this case they only have one form and cannot change forms. Creatures who started as Allies or Prey cannot change forms.

4.1.9 EXPERIENCED CHARACTERS

Several Characters have versions at different renown levels. These Characters are more (or less) experienced versions, and may not be in the same pack as one of their earlier incarnations. For example, Renown 8 *Mari Cabrah* may not be in the same pack as

Renown 6 *Mari Cabrah*. Why? Because they're both *Mari Cabrah*!

Similarly, *Lord* and *King Albrecht* are versions of the same Character as are *Questor Treetalker* and *Questor*.

Definition: The Silver Pack

The Silver Pack is elected at the grandest of Garou moots, and they are a representation of the first pack. Usually Silver Packs number between five and 10 members, but there is always at least one member of each auspice. Characters who are members of the Silver Pack will never attack another member of the Silver Pack; they are considered to have Loyalty: Silver Pack and can never be made Rivals of other Silver Pack members.

4.1.10 MODIFICATIONS TO STATISTICS

At times, a creature's Rage, Gnosis, Health or Renown scores are modified in some manner. For instance, Rage is frequently modified by combat actions, and Renown may be increased or doubled in moots by various abilities. In all cases, any multipliers (i.e., doubling) are applied first, then additions or subtractions.

A card ability (for instance, a firearm) that says "May play Rage X cards" does not give a creature a Rage of X. For instance, if a Character with a natural rage of 2 has a *Shotgun* (giving her the ability to play Rage 7 combat actions) is influenced by a *Battle Song* (+2 Rage), she does not gain the ability to play Rage 9 combat actions. Instead, she is now a Rage 4 Character with a *Shotgun*. Also, any card that lets you play Rage X combat actions also allows you to play combat actions of less Rage (so you can play a Rage 6 card with a *Shotgun*).

Other rules:

- No statistics have upper limits.
- Rage and Gnosis may never be below zero after all modifications.
- Any creature with a Health modified to zero is dead.
- You may only have one multiply effect (example: Quoting the Litany doubles your renown) applied to a stat at a time, but you may have multiple add or subtract effects applied.
- Renown modifiers on a creature never change the amount of VP that they are worth unless explicitly stated they do so. Other abilities may do so (e.g., *Scar Throat's* +2 VP for Vampires).

4.2 SEPT CARDS

Sept cards are the resources of the Characters in your pack and game altering cards. The sept deck includes the Equipment, special powers and other benefits that the Garou may draw upon. There are many different types of sept cards. Once you are out of sept cards, you may continue to play, but you will obviously not draw any sept cards during the Redraw phase.

Creatures may never have more than one copy of any sept card attached to them, unless it is a damage card.

Definition: Restricted

Each player can only play one of these per game. If the card is cancelled it still counts as played.

Some cards have other restrictions on how many times they can be played. If one of these is cancelled it still counts as played.

Definition: Unique

Only one copy of each Unique card may be in play at the same time. A player may not play a Unique card if a copy of it is already in play. If more than one player tries to play the same Unique card at the same time, randomly determine which player plays the card (return other copies to their owner's hand). A second copy of a Unique card may be played once the first one leaves play. Cards in Victory Piles do not count when testing for Uniqueness, but cards temporarily removed from play do.

4.3 SEPT CARDS: RESOURCES

Resources are a class of sept cards that represent permanent fixtures that benefit a pack. They last until they are destroyed or you no longer want them. There are various types of resource but they share common rules.

- All resources can only be played during the Resource phase. This takes an action by one of your Characters (or Allies for equipment). All resources have one or more requirements (keywords) listed, and the Character playing the resource must meet one of those requirements. Note that cards can also contain additional conditions in the text box which must be met (e.g. the user must be a Character or be in homid form), meeting or ignoring the keyword requirement is not enough. These additional conditions are not considered keyword requirements.
- All resources can be voluntarily discarded from play during the Resource phase. This does not require an action.
- All resources other than Equipment are considered pack resources: they are played to your Pack Home Ground and their use is not restricted to the creature that played them.

4.3.1 CAERNS

Caerns are mystical places of power for the Garou; they provide doorways between the physical and spirit worlds, and allow most Characters to step sideways. A pack may only have one Caern in play at a time and all named Caerns are Unique. Caerns exist on both sides of the Gauntlet and can be played by a creature on either side of the Gauntlet. While Caerns primary use is to allow pack members to step sideways, all members of the pack can use and benefit from the Caern's special ability, even if they cannot step sideways. For more information on using Caerns, see Umbra Phase and Rules for the Umbra.

4.3.2 EQUIPMENT

Equipment grants additional abilities to the bearer. When played, equipment is attached to the creature that played it. The requirements of equipment are only checked when first played or when transferred (form restrictions on use do not count as a requirement). Only the creature carrying the equipment can use its benefits and abilities (although some equipment has effects beyond the creature using it). Creatures can choose not to use equipment attached to them. A creature may normally only have one piece of Armor and one Weapon at a time.

Equipment types

Equipment is divided into (Gaia) Fetishes, Bane Fetishes and mundane ("Non-Fetish") equipment.

- The mystical items known as Fetishes can only be played by Gaia Characters and Allies. Fetishes list a minimum Gnosis score for a creature to play them, as an additional requirement.
- Bane Fetishes are the Wyrms' equivalent, empowered by Banes rather than Gaian or Wyld spirits. They can only be played by Wurm Characters and Wurm Allies and are not considered Fetishes. Bane Fetishes list a minimum Gnosis score for a creature to play them, as an additional requirement.
- Non-fetish equipment (also known as mundane or Techno equipment) includes more normal items such as guns and can be identified by the fact that they do not have a Gnosis requirement. Many non-Fetish items have restrictions on their use.
- Certain Fetishes are also Bane Fetishes - they may be used by any Character or Ally, Gaia or Wurm, and are affected by cards which affect either Fetishes or Bane Fetishes.

Trading

Characters and Allies may also trade or give Equipment (items) to another member of their own pack, or to a member of another pack if they agree. Equipment can only be traded during the Resource phase and only if the creature giving up the equipment had it at the beginning of turn. This is an action for the creature receiving the equipment, but not for the one giving it up. The creature receiving the equipment must also meet its requirements or it is discarded.

Prey and allies

Prey cannot normally be given Equipment, but if a creature receives equipment while a member of a pack and later enters the Hunting Grounds they do not lose the equipment and can continue to use it (see Prey). Equipment can be played by Allies providing they meet the requirements.

Built-in equipment

Certain creatures automatically have equipment (example: Kinfolk Soldier of Fortune has a shotgun). These pieces of equipment may never be traded away. Creatures with built-in firearms cannot have their Rage changed while armed. If the equipment is somehow disarmed, stolen or destroyed during combat, the creature no longer has access to that piece of equipment for the duration of the current combat (this does not affect Rage unless stated on the creature card). After combat, they automatically get a new copy of that equipment. If the built-in equipment is stolen or disarmed while the creature is not in combat, there is no effect - the creature immediately rearms itself. Creatures with built-in weapons cannot be given other weapons (similarly for armor, etc).

Weapons

A creature equipped with a weapon is assumed to be using that weapon.

4.3.3 TERRITORIES

Territories are special places that packs control and benefit from. They are similar to Caerns, though they are not as spiritual in nature and not as well hidden. Territory cards are instantly recognisable as they are laid out landscape rather than portrait. Packs may have any number of Territories in play at any point.

Using the special ability of a Territory is not considered an action, and may be done at any time unless otherwise specified. Territories exist on both sides of the Gauntlet and can be played by a creature either side of the Gauntlet. See rules for attacking Territories

4.3.3.A REALMS

Realms are a subset of Territories which represent connections to a pocket of the Umbra with different laws of reality.

They follow all rules for Territories except:

- The Character playing the Realm must be in the Umbra.
- Realms can only be attacked or targeted from the Umbra, but they effect both the real world and Umbra
- A pack can only have one Realm.

Note that Realms were previously their own card type.

4.3.4 BATTLEFIELDS

A Battlefield represents a skirmish with opposing groups that are not individually notable enough to warrant a character's notice. After all, a Garou can cut down a large number of Wyrms tainted humans with little to no difficulty. They are individually no threat. As a group however...

Renown: The Renown of a Battlefield is simply how many points you will acquire for defeating the Battlefield

Engaging Renown is how many renown worth of creatures you can use to attack or defend the Battlefield. This is an automatic pack attack or defense (depending on which side you are on)

Battlefields can only be engaged as an Alpha action. See Battlefield Combat for more.

4.4 SEPT CARDS: CREATURES

Characters are not the only creatures that appear in Rage. Allies and Prey are all creatures too and have stats, keywords, and special ability just like Characters. **Allies and Prey may not frenzy or step sideways.** They regenerate or not depending on creature class.

- Played in the Resource phase
- Cannot be voluntarily discarded from play
- Characters play Allies
- Players play Enemies and Victims

The Rage FOO Rule: if it's a FOO, it can use FOO cards. Prey and Allies with keywords can use Gifts and Equipment which require those keywords. Remember that all Wyrms spirits are Banes. Prey and Allies may not play Actions, Past Lives, Rites, Totems or pack resources. Equipment cannot be played on or traded to Prey.

Definition: Cannot be bound

Creatures that cannot be bound cannot be attacked to bind and also cannot be commanded, controlled or made an Ally.

This is often found on Spirits. Spirits that can't be bound cannot be affected by any Gifts SPECIFICALLY targeting spirits such as Exorcism or Spirit Drain.

4.4.1 ALLIES

Allies are the friends and associates of your pack. Like resources, recruiting Allies is an action taken by a Character who must meet the requirements of the Ally and must be in the same world as the Ally being recruited (normally the physical world).

- Allies are like Characters in that they are independent, can fight in combats, equip, join pack actions, act as alpha, etc.
- Allies are considered pack members and can gain benefits from pack resources and Pack Totems. Abilities that affect an entire pack also affect its Allies.
- Allies may **not**:
 - vote on or call Juntas;
 - recruit Allies;
 - play Caerns, Territories, Actions, Rites or Totems.
- Allies are removed from the game if all of your Characters have died or been permanently removed from the game

Sidebar: Adopting Allies

If you recruit an Enemy or Victim into your pack, it still retains all card text. For instance, if you pull a *Progenitor Mage* into a Wyrms pack, it will still attack at the end of the combat round, and you would get points for anything the *Mage* killed. While they are part of your pack, they are considered your Allies, not Enemies or Victims, so if they are worth their full VP to anyone who kills them. Those that normally attack Characters will not target your Characters with their automatic attacks.

As a corollary, a creature is either a Character, Ally, Enemy or Victim. If something causes a creature to change its status, the creature is no longer its original type. For example, a Character who is voted a *Skindancer* is now an Enemy, and all relevant rules for enemies apply to it. Therefore, it may no longer frenzy (since only Characters can frenzy), but a Wyrms alpha may step in to defend it if it is attacked.

Abilities which change a creature's type cannot be used during combat.

4.4.2 PREY: ENEMIES AND VICTIMS

Enemies are the Wyrms-tainted foes of the Garou, while Victims are the foes of the Wyrms' minions. Enemies and Victims are collectively known as Prey. Most Prey is played to be attacked for Victory Points, but some prey have useful special abilities. Unlike Allies and resources, Prey are placed in the Hunting Grounds when played and do not become members of a pack.

- Prey cannot use Combat Events. They can use Gifts (see below).
- For combat involving prey, see Playing for Prey
- Enemies killed by Wyrms packs are worth 0 VP. Except during combat, their special abilities do not affect Wyrms creatures.
- Victims killed by Gaia packs are worth 0 VP. Except during combat, their special abilities do not affect Gaia creatures.

See VP Complications for more on Prey

Prey using Gifts

Prey, like Allies, can use Gifts which they meet the requirements for (see Gifts)

- Prey can only use Gifts during combat (although they do not have to be in the combat themselves).
- Any player may play gifts for them, unless the player has Characters or allies in combat against the Prey.
- These gifts may target anyone; for instance a *Progenitor Mage* might cast a *Distractions* on a combat he is not involved in, or *Mother's Touch* your wounds for you (as long as you are not fighting him).
- A Prey gift-caster will not cancel his own attacks or gifts, and will never affect himself with a detrimental gift.

Prey which attacks

- Some Allies, Enemies and Victims will attack creatures during the combat phase. Treat this as a declared attack from the Prey creature against its intended target.
- Prey will only attack valid targets. If the creature the Prey would normally attack is not a valid target (e.g. it is in the Umbra), it will go after the next available valid target.
- To determine the order of attacks where more than one creature is declaring attacks at the end of turn, use the Renown of the attackers to determine attack order. If tied, break the tie randomly.
- Creatures that attack for a specified duration (e.g. two rounds) will automatically escape after that many rounds.

Remember, an Enemy will not go after a Wyrms target, and a Victim will not go after a Gaia target - unless specifically noted on the card. Prey will never declare attacks against other prey.

4.5 SEPT CARDS: OPEN PLAY CARDS

The following types of sept card can be played at "any time", or rather during any period of Open Play (or as dictated by the card effect). Most also have keyword requirements which must be met by the creature using them. The effects of these cards cannot cross the gauntlet (except for Events).

Some of these cards have instant effects (and are discarded immediately), some stay around a lot longer. There are some common clues as to duration. "Discard after use" always indicates that the card has an instant effect, while "permanent until cancelled" means that it is permanent. There are also clues on when instant and ongoing effects can be played. If they refer to an "opponent", "combat" or "combat round" then they can normally only be played in combat. Such cards cannot be played ahead of time - their effects take place immediately they are played. Permanent effects normally do not have specific timing. These are, of course, generalisations.

Any card with an ongoing or permanent effect remains in play until the effect ends or the card is cancelled. If the card is cancelled or discarded, all its effects end immediately. Cards with a permanent effect attach to either the creature

Sidebar: Actions and actions

There is a big difference between Action cards (with a capital) and actions (without). The former are a specific type of sept card that can be used by Characters. The latter refers to most things that creatures can do. It is important to note which effects are actions and which are not due to abilities which prevent creatures taking actions. These occurrences are considered actions. Those actions noted with asterisks may be taken at any time of Open Play (as limited by the card).

- Playing an Action card *
- Playing a Gift card *
- Playing a Rite card *
- Playing a Caern or Territory
- Equipping
- Bringing an Ally into play
- Stepping sideways
- Playing a Moot or BoardMeeting card
- Voting in a Junta
- Undertaking an alpha action
- Stepping in
- Defending a Territory
- Defending a Battlefield
- Playing a Combat Action

The following occurrences are **not** considered actions. Again, those noted with asterisks may be done at any time.

- Using a creature's special ability
- Playing an Event card *
- Playing a Quest card *
- Playing a Past Life *
- Using a piece of Equipment *
- Playing a Battlefield
- Bringing Prey into play
- Using the special ability of a Caern or Territory *
- Regenerating
- Playing, or being affected by, a Combat Event
- Being Alpha
- Withdrawing from a combat